

Let  $F$  be a field of characteristic is not 2.

Let  $D_1, D_2 \in F$ , neither of which is a square in  $F$ .

If  $\sqrt{D_1 D_2} \notin F$ , then  $F(\sqrt{D_1}, \sqrt{D_2})$  is degree 4 over  $F$ ,

If  $\sqrt{D_1 D_2} \in F$ , then // degree 2.

Proof. Clearly,  $[F(\sqrt{D_1}) : F] = 2$ , because  $\sqrt{D_1} \notin F$  but  $D_1 \in F$ .

Suppose that  $\sqrt{D_1 D_2} \notin F$ . Then,  $\sqrt{D_2} \notin F(\sqrt{D_1})$ , because; if  $\sqrt{D_2} \in F(\sqrt{D_1})$ , then

$$\sqrt{D_2} = a\sqrt{D_1} + b \text{ for some } a, b \in F.$$

But, this implies

$$D_2 + a^2 D_1 - 2a\sqrt{D_1}\sqrt{D_2} = b^2 \Rightarrow \sqrt{D_1}\sqrt{D_2} = \frac{1}{2a} \cdot (b^2 - a^2 D_1 - D_2) \in F.$$

if  $a \neq 0$ . (Since  $\text{ch}(F) \neq 2$ ,  $2 \neq 0$ ). And in case of  $a=0$ ,

$\sqrt{D_2} = b \in F$ , so both case are contradiction

So,  $[F(\sqrt{D_1}, \sqrt{D_2}) : F(\sqrt{D_1})] > 1$ , exactly 2.

But, if  $\sqrt{D_1 D_2} \in F$ , then  $\sqrt{D_1 D_2} = a$  for some nonzero  $a \in F$ . Now,

$$\sqrt{D_2} = \frac{a}{\sqrt{D_1}} \in F(\sqrt{D_1}), \text{ so it has degree of 2.}$$

More observation: Let  $a, b \in F$  be given, with  $\sqrt{b} \notin F$ . Then,

$$\sqrt{a + \sqrt{b}} = \sqrt{m} + \sqrt{n} \text{ for some } m, n \in F \text{ iff } \sqrt{a^2 - b} \in F.$$

Proof. Suppose the left assertion holds. Then,

$$a + \sqrt{b} = m + n + 2\sqrt{mn} \Rightarrow a - (m+n) = 2\sqrt{mn} - \sqrt{b} \in F.$$

So,  $2\sqrt{mn} - \sqrt{b}$  must be zero, because <sup>if</sup>  $2\sqrt{mn} - \sqrt{b} = k \neq 0$ , then

$$2mn = k^2 + b + 2k\sqrt{b} \Rightarrow \sqrt{b} = \frac{1}{2k} (2mn - k^2 - b) \in F, \text{ contradiction.}$$

Thus,  $2\sqrt{mn} = \sqrt{b}$  and  $a = m+n$ ,  $a^2 - b = (m+n)^2 - 4mn = (m-n)^2$ ,  
or  $\sqrt{a^2 - b} = m-n \in F$ . Conversely, if  $\sqrt{a^2 - b} \in F$ , then take

$$m = \frac{1}{2}(a + \sqrt{a^2 - b}) \text{ and } n = \frac{1}{2}(a - \sqrt{a^2 - b}). \text{ Then,}$$

$$(m-n)^2 = a^2 - b, \quad 4mn = b, \text{ so } (\sqrt{m} + \sqrt{n})^2 = m+n + 2\sqrt{mn} = a + \sqrt{b}.$$

Using the observation above, for  $a, b \in \mathbb{Q}$ ,

$\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{a+b})$  is biquadratic 'if and only if

$$\sqrt{a^2-b} \in \mathbb{Q} \text{ and } \frac{a \pm \sqrt{a^2-b}}{2} \notin \mathbb{Q}.$$

Example

Evaluate the degree of  $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{3+2\sqrt{2}})$  over  $\mathbb{Q}$

Since  $\sqrt{3+2\sqrt{2}} = \sqrt{3+\sqrt{8}}$ ,  $9-8=1$  is square in  $\mathbb{Q}$ .

But,  $\sqrt{\frac{3 \pm \sqrt{1}}{2}} = 1$  or  $0$ , squares, it is not biquadratic.

Specifically, take  $m = \frac{1}{2}(3+1) = 2$ ,  $n = \frac{1}{2}(3-1)$ , so

$$\sqrt{3+2\sqrt{2}} = \sqrt{m} + \sqrt{n} = \sqrt{2} + 1, \text{ so } \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{3+2\sqrt{2}}) = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2}+1) = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2}).$$

Degree 2.

Similarly, for  $\sqrt{3+4i}$ , take  $m = \frac{1}{2}(3+5) = 4$ ,  $n = \frac{1}{2}(3-5) = -1$ .

$$\sqrt{3+4i} = 2+i, \text{ and } \sqrt{3-4i} = 2-i, \text{ so,}$$

$$\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{3+4i} + \sqrt{3-4i}) = \mathbb{Q}.$$

Galois Group of Biquadratic Extension.

Let  $F$  be a field, and  $D_1, D_2 \in F$  s.t.  $\sqrt{D_1}, \sqrt{D_2}, \sqrt{D_1 D_2} \notin F$ .

Then,  $K = F(\sqrt{D_1}, \sqrt{D_2})$  is biquadratic.

Moreover,  $\text{Gal}(K/F) \cong \mathbb{Z}_2 \times \mathbb{Z}_2$ .